



NOVALITY STORE • PREMIUM EDITION

Christmas Gift Tracker

USER GUIDE

Every gift, every dollar, every deadline — your five-minute tour of the planner that does the maths for you.



Excel 2016 +

Microsoft 365

Mac

Google Sheets

No macros

Merry Christmas! 🎄

What you downloaded

Your purchase arrived as three Excel files (.xlsx). Nothing to install, nothing to enable — here is what each one is for.



PREMIUM — Festive

Your real planner. Classic Christmas reds & greens, watercolour cover.

Excel & Google Sheets



PREMIUM — Minimal

The exact same engine in a clean, modern look. Pick whichever you prefer.

Excel & Google Sheets



EXAMPLE — filled in

The demo from the listing pictures: 14 recipients, 25 gifts, every formula working.

Excel & Google Sheets

start here!



OPEN THE EXAMPLE FILE FIRST

Spend two minutes clicking around a tracker that is already full.

When you are ready to plan for real, open a PREMIUM file and type over the demo content — or start from a blank row.

⚙️ What you need

- ✓ Excel 2016 or later (Windows or Mac), or Microsoft 365 — no older versions, no OpenOffice
- ✓ Google Sheets: import the file in four clicks (full walkthrough on page 11)
- ✓ No macros, no add-ins, no internet needed — it is pure formulas, so it also works offline
- ✓ A printer, if you like paper: every tab is already set up to print neatly



IF EXCEL SHOWS A YELLOW BAR

Files downloaded from the internet open in Protected View. Click “Enable Editing” at the top and everything wakes up. There are no macros in this file, so nothing else is required.

The three-minute setup

Setup — make it yours [Back to Dashboard](#)

Three minutes, no formulas to write: set your date, budget and people — every tab updates instantly.

🎄 event: Christmas 2026 💰 budget: \$1,500 📢 alert: 85% 🛡️ Secret Mode: off

Your event

Event name:

Event date:
every deadline in the workbook recalculates from this

Countdown message:

Occasion: 18 occasions pre-loaded — birthdays, weddings, Diwali...

Money & alerts

Currency:

Total budget:
feeds the Budget tab & all the alerts

Alert me at: 🌐

Due-soon window: 🌐

Secret Mode

Hide gift ideas & costs from anyone peeking over your shoulder.

🛡️ Off — everyone can see everything

🔒 On — ideas & costs hidden, 1-click toggle

Your people

16 recipient slots • 16 stockings • 100+ gift rows

Christmas Gift Tracker © Novality Store Excel & Google Sheets

- 1 Set your event**
 ⚙️ Setup Event name and Event date. Every countdown, deadline and key date in the workbook is calculated from that one date — nothing is hard-coded to a year.
- 2 Make the money yours**
 On the same tab: currency, total budget, the % that triggers the budget warning, and how many days count as “due soon”.
- 3 Type your people**
 ⚙️ Setup Your lists: recipients, relationships, stores, categories, hiding spots. Every dropdown in every tab reads from these lists.
- 4 Add your gifts**
 📦 Gift Tracker: one row per present. Use the Status dropdown as your pipeline — idea to delivered.
- 5 Plan the money**
 💰 Budget: type a planned amount per category. Everything else on that tab is automatic.
- 6 Enjoy the dashboard**
 🌲 Dashboard needs no typing at all — it recalculates the moment you change anything anywhere.

🏆 THE GOLDEN RULES

White cells are yours — type in them freely. Tinted cells are formula cells: they are locked so the maths can never break.

Pick✓ from the dropdowns instead of typing it — the tick columns feed the dashboards.

Don't rename tabs or delete the hidden `_Data` sheet; the whole workbook reads from them.

The Dashboard — your command centre

You never type on this tab. It is a live picture of everything you have done everywhere else — open it every morning of December and it will tell you what needs doing.



What each part is telling you

- ✓ Countdown band — days and weeks until Christmas, from your event date
- ✓ Money cards — budget, spent, remaining and % used, plus the amber warning when you cross your alert level
- ✓ Progress cards — planned, bought, wrapped, given, on order, average spend per person
- ✓ Progress bars — the block bars fill up as you buy and wrap
- ✓ Four charts — spending per person, budget vs actual, where the gifts are at, bought vs still to buy
- ✓ What's left to do — plain-English sentences written by the formulas ("4 gifts still to buy, 3 already on order...")
- ✓ Next deadlines — the five closest dates from every tab, with a days-left chip that goes amber inside your due-soon window
- ✓ Per-recipient summary — budget vs spend and a mini bar for every person on your list

Gift Tracker — the heart of it

💡 Idea
🛒 Need to Buy
📦 Ordered
✅ Purchased
🎁 Wrapped
📦 Delivered

📦 Gift Tracker
🏠 Back to Dashboard

Every present in one place — type in the white cells, the tinted cells do the maths.

🎯 25 gifts planned
✅ 18 bought
🎁 13 wrapped
📦 6 handed over
🛒 4 still to buy
📈 72% complete

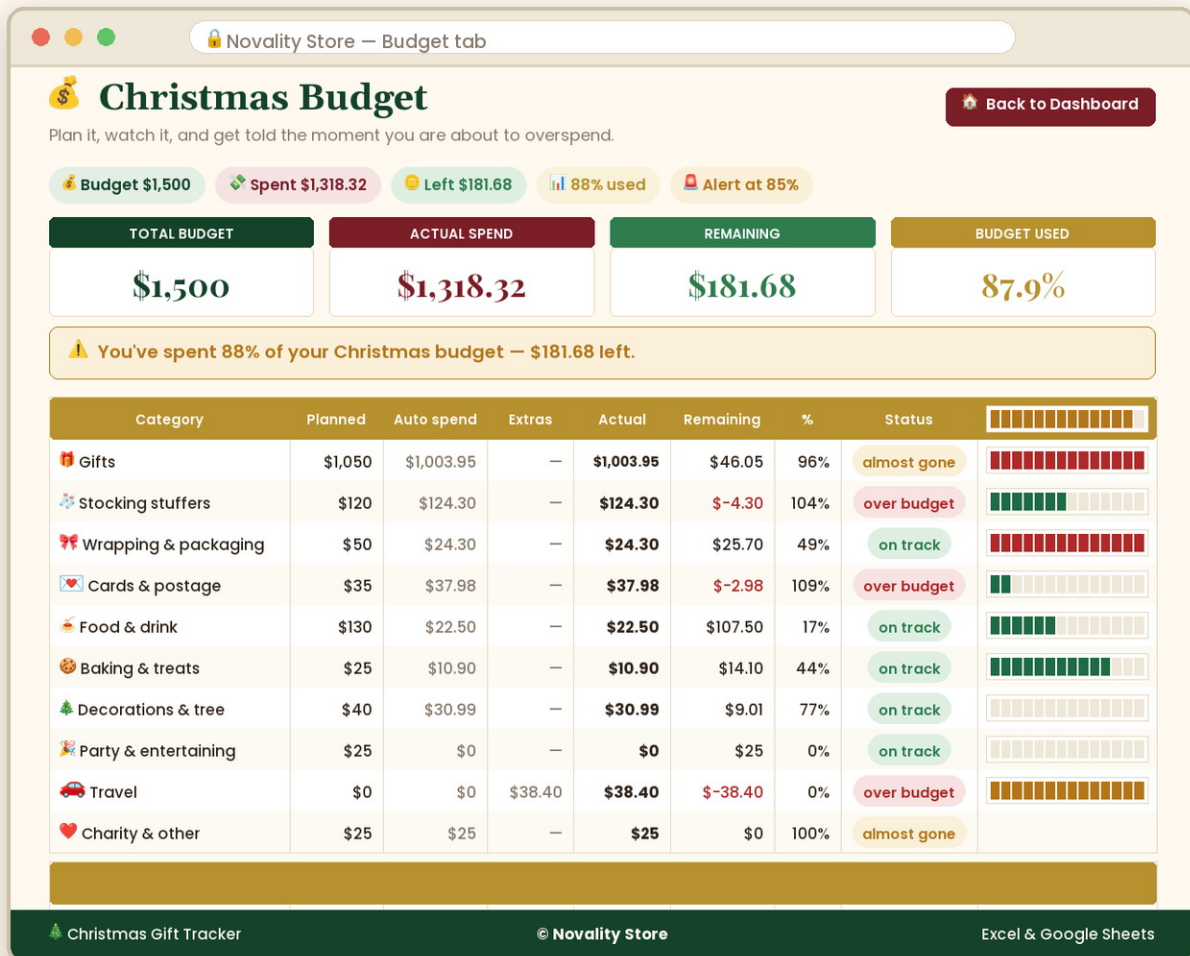
For	Gift idea	Category	Budget	Cost	Status	🎁 Wrap	Buy by	Deadline alert
Mum	Cashmere scarf	Clothing	\$60	\$55	✅ Purchased	✓	15 Dec	—
Mum	Spa gift set	Beauty	\$45	\$42.99	🎁 Wrapped	✓	15 Dec	—
Dad	Whisky tasting set	Food & Drink	\$55	\$55	✅ Purchased	✓	17 Dec	—
Grandma Rose	Digital photo frame	Electronics	\$90	\$84.99	📦 Ordered		20 Dec	—
Grandma Rose	Chunky knitted blanket	Handmade	\$45	\$45	🎁 Wrapped	✓	13 Dec	—
Sister Emily	Gold hoop earrings	Jewellery	\$50	\$48	🎁 Wrapped	✓	19 Dec	—
Sister Emily	Bath bomb gift box	Beauty	\$25	—	🛒 Need to Buy		19 Dec	on track
Brother Jack	Wireless earbuds	Electronics	\$80	\$74.99	📦 Ordered		21 Dec	—
Brother Jack	Craft beer hamper	Food & Drink	\$35	\$33	✅ Purchased		16 Dec	—
Niece Sophie	Art supplies case	Kids	\$22	\$20	🎁 Wrapped	✓	18 Dec	—
Nephew Leo	Dinosaur museum tickets	Experience	\$40	\$36	✅ Purchased		22 Dec	—
Nephew Leo	Graphic novel bundle	Books	\$25	—	💡 Idea		22 Dec	on track
TOTALS		25 gifts						
TOTALS		25 gifts planned	\$1,177	\$1,022.95	72% done	avg \$77.92/present		

🎄 Christmas Gift Tracker
© Novality Store
Excel & Google Sheets

📝 How to fill it in

- ✓ One row per present: who it is for, the idea, category, store and your budget — the dropdowns read your Setup lists
- ✓ The Status column is your pipeline: move each gift along the six stages as you go; the dashboard counts them automatically
- ✓ Cost, difference, % of budget, days left and the alert column are all tinted — they fill themselves in
- ✓ Buy-by dates come from your event date; a gift inside the due-soon window turns amber, an overdue one turns red
- ✓ Wrapped✓ and Given✓ are the last two ticks — tick them and the Wrapping tab updates itself

Budget — watch every dollar



Planned vs automatic vs manual

- ✓ Planned — type your target for each of the 10 categories (rename them if your Christmas looks different)
- ✓ Pulled in automatically — the tinted column adds up the real money from the Gift Tracker, Shopping List, Stockings and card postage
- ✓ Extras — for spending that lives outside the tabs (travel, the tree, the turkey), type it once in the manual column
- ✓ Remaining and % used recalculate instantly; a category over budget turns red, nearly over turns amber
- ✓ The banner at the top warns you in plain English the moment you cross the % you set in Setup (default 85%)

Wish List & Shopping List

💡 Wish List — ideas all year round

Novality Store — Wish List

Wish List & Gift Ideas

Hints all year round, ranked by how much they really want them.

💡 12 ideas saved ★ 5 must-haves 💰 \$590 value

[Back to Dashboard](#)

Person	Idea	Category	Priority	Price	On the gift list?
Alex (partner)	Engraved watch	Jewellery	★★★★ Must Have	\$95	✓ copied to Gifts
Alex (partner)	Cast iron skillet	Home	★★ Maybe	\$45	— saved
Mum	Cashmere scarf	Clothing	★★★★ Must Have	\$60	✓ copied to Gifts
Mum	Gardening book	Books	★ Low Priority	\$18	— saved
Sister Emily	Bath bomb gift box	Beauty	★★★★ Must Have	\$25	✓ copied to Gifts
Sister Emily	Silk pillowcase	Home	★★ Maybe	\$32	— saved
Nephew Leo	Graphic novel bundle	Books	★★ Maybe	\$25	✓ copied to Gifts
Niece Sophie	Watercolour set	Kids	★ Low Priority	\$20	— saved

- ✓ Park every “they mentioned it in March” idea here, ranked ★ to ★★★★★ Must Have
- ✓ The last column tells you when an idea has already made it onto the gift list — no duplicate presents

🛒 Shopping List — the quiet budget-eaters

Novality Store — Shopping List

Shopping List

Wrapping, cards, baking, decorations, party bits — the stuff that quietly eats the budget.

🛒 24 items ✅ 13 bought 💰 \$163.39 spent

[Back to Dashboard](#)

Item	Category	Store	Qty	Unit	Cost	Bought	Notes
Wrapping paper - 3 roll pack	Wrapping	Target	3	\$4	\$11.50	✓	Gold foil design
Ribbon - red & gold	Wrapping	Amazon	2	\$3.50	\$6.80	✓	—
Gift tags (pack of 50)	Wrapping	Etsy	1	\$6	\$6	✓	Hand-lettered
Sticky tape & scissors	Wrapping	Target	1	\$5	—		—
Tissue paper bundle	Wrapping	Target	1	\$3	—		—
Christmas cards (box of 30)	Cards	Amazon	1	\$14	\$13.50	✓	—
Stamps - book of 30	Postage	Post office	1	\$20.40	\$20.40	✓	—
Thank-you notes	Cards	Etsy	1	\$8	—		For January

- ✓ Wrapping paper, cards, baking, decorations, party bits — with quantities and unit costs
- ✓ Everything you tick as bought rolls straight into the Budget tab, so December surprises stop happening

Order Tracker & Wrapping

📦 Online Order Tracker

Online Order Tracker

Parcels, couriers and cut-off dates — nothing arrives on the 27th on your watch.

8 orders 4 still out 0 late 417.47 tracked

For	Item	Store	Order number	Expected	Days left	Status	Cost
Grandma Rose	Digital photo frame	Amazon	112-4471902-55...	22 Dec	101 days	Shipped	\$84.99
Brother Jack	Wireless earbuds	Best Buy	BB-9938-2211...	21 Dec	100 days	Out for Delivery	\$74.99
Alex (partner)	Engraved watch	Etsy	ETSY-778201...	19 Dec	98 days	Shipped	\$89
Dad	Leather wallet	Amazon	112-8830042-11...	11 Dec	arrived✓	Delivered	\$38.50
Niece Sophie	LEGO Friends set	Amazon	112-2291047-99...	07 Dec	arrived✓	Delivered	\$39.99
Maya (bestfriend)	Scented candle trio	Not On The High Street	NOTHS-55231...	05 Dec	arrived✓	Delivered	\$28.50
Aunt Carol	Silk scarf	M&S	MS-4419287...	04 Dec	arrived✓	Delivered	\$37.50
Sister Emily	Bath bomb gift box	Sephora	SEPH-88213...	24 Dec	103 days	Ordered	\$24

Christmas Gift Tracker © Novality Store Excel & Google Sheets

- ✓ Order number, store, cost, expected and actual arrival dates — one row per parcel
- ✓ Days-left counts down from your event date; the day after it was due, a parcel turns red — chase the courier
- ✓ The returns window is calculated for you (typically 14 January)

🎀 Wrapping & Hiding

Wrapping & Hiding

Mirrors your gift list automatically — add the hiding spot and the gift tag here.

13 wrapped 5 still to wrap 7 to hand over Secret Mode off

For	Gift	Wrapped	Hiding spot	Tag	Handed over
Mum	Cashmere scarf	wrapped✓	—	—	waiting
Mum	Spa gift set	wrapped✓	Top shelf in closet	✓	waiting
Dad	Leather wallet	wrapped✓	Car boot / trunk	✓	✓
Dad	Whisky tasting set	wrapped✓	—	—	waiting
Grandma Rose	Chunky knitted blanket	wrapped✓	Suitcase in the attic	✓	waiting
Grandpa Joe	Crossword book bundle	wrapped✓	Behind the books	✓	✓
Grandpa Joe	Heated slippers	wrapped✓	Under the bed	✓	✓
Sister Emily	Gold hoop earrings	wrapped✓	Linen closet	✓	waiting
Niece Sophie	LEGO Friends set	wrapped✓	Garage shelf	✓	✓
Niece Sophie	Art supplies case	wrapped✓	Top shelf in closet	—	waiting

Back to Dashboard

- ✓ Mirrors your gift list automatically — add the hiding spot and the To/From tag
- ✓ Wrapped and handed-over are tracked separately, so nothing gets “found” early and nothing is left under the bed on 26 December

Card Tracker & Stockings

📧 Christmas Card Tracker

📧 **Christmas Card Tracker** [Back to Dashboard](#)

Bought written posted replied. Nobody gets forgotten, and postage lands in your budget.

📧 14 cards 📝 9 written 📬 7 posted 💰 \$4.08 postage

Name	Relation	Address	Bought	Written	Posted	Stamp	Status
Grandma Rose	Grandma	14 Rosewood Lane, Harrogate HG1 2AB, UK	✓	✓	✓	0.68	✓ all done
Grandpa Joe	Grandpa	14 Rosewood Lane, Harrogate HG1 2AB, UK	✓	✓	✓	0.68	✓ all done
Aunt Carol	Aunt	88 Maple Drive, Leeds LS6 4QT, UK	✓	✓	✓	0.68	✓ all done
Uncle Bill	Uncle	88 Maple Drive, Leeds LS6 4QT, UK	✓	✓	✓	0.68	✓ all done
Cousin Dan	Cousin	3 Ash Court, Manchester M1 5AN, UK	✓	✓	✓	0.68	✓ all done
Cousin Priya	Cousin	3 Ash Court, Manchester M1 5AN, UK	✓	✓		0.00	in progress
Maya (best friend)	Friend	27b Kingsland Road, London E2 8AA, UK	✓	✓	✓	0.68	✓ all done
Tom & Jess	Friend	5 Cedar Walk, Bristol BS1 4TR, UK	✓	✓		0.00	in progress
Mrs Higgins (neighbour)	Neighbour	9 Birch Hill, York YO1 7HD, UK	✓			0.00	in progress
Ms Patel (teacher)	Teacher	St Anne's Primary, School Office	✓			0.00	in progress
SUMMARY			14 people	14 / 14	9	7	\$4.08 auto-added to Budget tab

📧 Christmas Gift Tracker © Novality Store Excel & Google Sheets

- ✓ Bought written posted replied: four ticks per person, nobody gets forgotten
- ✓ Postage is added up and lands in your Budget automatically

🧦 Stocking Stuffer Tracker

🧦 **Stocking Stuffer Tracker** [Back to Dashboard](#)

The little things add up fastest – budget them per stocking and stop the January regret.

🧦 16 items ✓ 13 bought 💰 \$108.50 spent 💰 \$144 budgeted

Stocking	Item	Type	Budget	Cost	Bought	Hiding spot
Emma	Lip balm trio	Beauty	\$8	\$7.50	✓	Top shelf in closet
Emma	Hair clips set	Hair clips	\$6	\$5	✓	Top shelf in closet
Emma	Chocolate coins	Chocolate	\$5	\$4.20	✓	Under the bed
Emma	Mini diary & pen	Stationery	\$9	\$8		—
Emma	Fuzzy socks	Socks	\$7	\$6.50	✓	Linen closet
Oliver	Dinosaur figures	Small toy	\$12	\$11	✓	Garage shelf
Oliver	Candy cane pack	Candy	\$4	\$3.80	✓	Back of the pantry
Oliver	Football stickers	Novelty	\$6	\$5.50	✓	Shoe box in wardrobe
Oliver	Comic book	Stationery	\$7	—		—
Oliver	Bath bubble bombs	Beauty	\$8	\$7	✓	Linen closet
TOTALS			16 items	\$144	\$108.50	13 bought mirrors the Budget tab

📧 Christmas Gift Tracker © Novality Store Excel & Google Sheets

- ✓ The little things add up fastest – budget per stocking and watch the per-owner summary
- ✓ Bought, wrapped and hidden are tracked per filler; costs roll into the Budget tab

To-Do List & next Christmas

Christmas To-Do List

Pre-loaded with the classic holiday checklist — every deadline is calculated from your event date.

7 of 20 done 0 overdue deadlines auto-set re-usable every year

Done	Task	Category	Deadline	Days left	Status
✓	Write the gift list & set the budget	Gifts	11 Oct	done✓	✓ Done
✓	Order Christmas cards	Cards	26 Oct	done✓	✓ Done
✓	Buy wrapping paper, ribbon & tags	Wrapping	10 Nov	done✓	✓ Done
	Address & write all cards	Cards	20 Nov	69 days	on the list
	Post the cards	Cards	30 Nov	79 days	on the list
✓	Order gifts that need delivery time	Gifts	25 Nov	done✓	✓ Done
✓	Buy the main gifts	Gifts	04 Dec	done✓	✓ Done
	Prepare the stockings	Gifts	07 Dec	86 days	on the list
✓	Buy the decorations & set up the tree	Decorations	05 Dec	done✓	✓ Done
	Plan the Christmas dinner menu	Food	11 Dec	90 days	on the list
	Book travel / check the car	Travel	04 Dec	83 days	on the list
	Bake cookies & treats	Food	15 Dec	94 days	on the list

SUMMARY 7 of 20 complete next: 20 Nov auto re-dates from EventDate

Christmas Gift Tracker © Novality Store Excel & Google Sheets

- ✓ 20 classic Christmas tasks come pre-loaded, each with a deadline calculated from your event date
- ✓ Tick the ✓ column as you go; overdue tasks turn red, coming-up ones amber

Use it again next year — and for every occasion

- Change the date**
⚙️ Setup Event date 25 Dec 2027 (or any occasion: birthdays, Diwali, weddings...). Every countdown, deadline and to-do re-dates itself.
- Clear your rows**
Select the white cells in the Gift Tracker, Orders, Cards, Stockings and To-Do tabs and press Delete. Your people, stores and categories in Setup stay put.
- Start planning**
Your Wish List carried over — the ideas you parked in January are exactly where you need them in November.

Christmas
 Secret Santa
 Birthdays
 Weddings
 Diwali
 Baby Shower
 + 12 more

Using it in Google Sheets

The same file works in both. Start in Excel, move to Sheets, or skip Excel entirely — the import takes under a minute.

- 1 Open Sheets**
Go to sheets.google.com (free with any Google account) and start a blank spreadsheet.
- 2 File Import**
Choose the Upload tab and drag your .xlsx file in — or click “Select a file from your device”.
- 3 Replace spreadsheet**
In Import settings choose “Replace spreadsheet” so every tab arrives together, then click Import data.
- 4 Done**
Dropdowns, colours, conditional formatting, locked cells and charts all come along. Formulas become Google-native formulas.

What converts

- ✓ All 2,500+ formulas (translated to Google Sheets equivalents)
- ✓ All 56 dropdown menus and every conditional-format colour rule
- ✓ Sheet protection — the formula cells stay locked in Sheets too
- ✓ Charts — Google Sheets rebuilds them from the same data

GOOD TO KNOW

Keep the original .xlsx — it is your master copy and works in Excel, Google Sheets and (formulas only) Apple Numbers.

Editing on the phone app works for quick ticks; the dashboard is happiest on a laptop or tablet screen.

Troubleshooting & FAQ

Q The numbers look wrong or stale

Press F9 (Ctrl+F9 on Mac) to force a recalculation. In Google Sheets reload the page. If you typed into a tinted cell by mistake, press Ctrl+Z.

Q A dropdown is missing a name

Add the person or store on the  Setup tab — every dropdown updates instantly.

Q I typed in a formula cell and it broke

The tinted cells are locked, so this should not be possible. If a value looks odd, Ctrl+Z straight away, or re-download your files from Etsy.

Q Can I add more rows?

Yes — insert rows inside the existing tables (not above the first row) and the formulas copy down with them.

Q Can I print it?

Every tab has print areas set. File → Print, and it fits the page — the block progress bars are designed for exactly that.

Q Where do I get updates?

Lifetime updates are included: re-download from Etsy → You → Purchases any time.

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Stuck or spotted a bug? Message Novality Store on Etsy — we reply within a day.

Merry Christmas, from all of us at Novality Store 

